

আমার চারপাশে সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Blu Foundation | Class 3 | Ages 8–9 Version: 1.0 DRAFT | Date: June 2026

A Note to Students

Hello, Class 3!

This book is about something you do every single day — even if you don't notice it. It's about **respect**.

Respect means treating people around you with care. It means listening when someone is talking. It means being kind in the mosque, on the bus, at school, and at home. It means saying sorry when you make a mistake — and really meaning it.

In this book, you will meet characters like Rafi, Mitu, and Karim. They make mistakes sometimes — just like we all do! But they learn. And so will you.

The best part? We will learn by **acting it out**. You will take on roles, try different choices, and discover what respect really looks like in real life.

Get ready to think, laugh, and practise. Let's begin!

Parents / অভিভাবকদের প্রতি [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Dear Parent or Guardian,

Your child is beginning a special journey in learning about respect, kindness, and responsibility. This textbook is part of Blu Foundation's Social-Emotional Learning (SEL) curriculum for Class 3.

In the coming weeks, your child will:

- Learn how to greet elders and visitors respectfully
- Practise good manners in public spaces
- Understand appropriate behaviour in holy places
- Learn to apologise sincerely and accept forgiveness

How you can help: At the end of each chapter, you will find a **Parent Corner** with one simple action you can take at home. These are short — just a few minutes — but they make a lasting difference.

Children learn best when home and school work together. Thank you for being part of this.

Warm regards, **The Blu Foundation Team**

A Note to Teachers

Welcome to BLU_D07: "Respect Around Me" — a textbook designed for Class 3 students aged 8 to 9.

Pedagogical approach: This book is built around **role play and group activities**. Research consistently shows that children this age learn social skills most effectively when they enact scenarios, discuss outcomes, and reflect together — rather than simply reading rules. Every chapter contains a full role play script, discussion questions, a branching "What Would You Do?" scenario, and a home activity.

How to use this book:

- **Before each role play:** Assign character roles in advance. Give students a moment to read their lines quietly. Encourage expression and natural delivery — not memorisation.
- **During role plays:** Allow for laughter. Natural, playful delivery helps children remember lessons far better than solemn recitation.
- **After each role play:** Use the Discussion Questions to debrief. The questions are designed to move from comprehension (What happened?) to empathy (How would you feel?) to application (What will YOU do?).
- **Teacher Notes** at the end of each chapter include specific facilitation guidance.

Cultural sensitivity: Bangladesh is home to Muslim, Hindu, Christian, and Buddhist communities, among others. This textbook acknowledges greetings and practices from multiple traditions. Please handle these discussions with care and celebration of diversity.

Duration: Each chapter is designed for one 45-minute class session, with the home activity bridging to the next session.

Chapter 1: Elders Know More — Respecting Elders

Virtue: Respect | সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will demonstrate 3 forms of respectful behaviour toward elders consistently.

Role Play: "Rafi and the Visitors"

Characters:

- **Rafi** — 8 years old, energetic, sometimes forgets his manners
- **Nanu (নানু)** — Rafi's maternal grandmother, warm and patient
- **Chacha (চাচা)** — the neighbour uncle, visits often, very traditional
- **Karim** — Rafi's best friend, also 8, visiting for the afternoon

[SCENE: Rafi's home. Rafi and Karim are in the sitting room, playing a loud clapping game and laughing. They are singing a silly rhyme at the top of their voices. The room is a little messy — Rafi's school bag is on the sofa.]

Rafi: *(clapping and laughing)* One-two-three, you can't catch me! Again, Karim! Faster!

Karim: *(clapping even harder)* HA! I always win! Do it again!

[The front door opens. Nanu enters slowly, carrying a small bag. Chacha enters just behind her. Neither Rafi nor Karim notices. They keep playing.]

Nanu: *(quietly, to herself)* Hmm. Very lively today.

Chacha: *(raises an eyebrow and clears his throat loudly)* Ahem.

[Rafi and Karim do not stop. They are too absorbed in the game.]

Chacha: *(louder, but kindly)* AHEM.

[Rafi finally looks up. His eyes go wide.]

Rafi: *(startled)* Oh! Nanu! And... Chacha! I didn't hear you come in.

Karim: *(freezing mid-clap, looking embarrassed)* As-salamu... um... hello?

Nanu: *(smiling)* Hello, children. Were you having fun?

Rafi: *(sheepishly)* Yes, Nanu. Sorry, we were just playing.

Chacha: *(sitting down — but wait, the sofa has Rafi's bag on it)* Hmm. *(He looks at the bag. He looks at Rafi.)*

Rafi: *(confused for a moment, then suddenly understanding)* Oh! Sorry, Chacha! Let me move that.

****[Rafi quickly grabs his bag off the sofa and places it on the floor. Chacha sits down with a satisfied nod.]***

Nanu: *(still standing)* Rafi, beta. Where should your old Nanu sit?

Rafi: *(looking around)* Oh, Nanu! Here — take my chair! *(He jumps up and offers his chair with both hands, gesturing politely.)*

Nanu: *(sitting down, pleased)* Ah! Thank you, my dear. You see, Karim? He remembered.

Karim: *(a little lost)* Remembered what?

Nanu: That when an elder comes into the room, you stand up. You offer your seat. You do not keep sitting as if they are invisible.

Karim: Oh. *(looks down)* I didn't do that.

Rafi: *(quietly, to Karim)* Don't worry. My Nanu will teach us. She always does.

Nanu: *(overhearing, chuckling)* That is correct! I always do. Now. Let us start again. Rafi, Karim — greet us properly. Pretend I just walked in.

****[Both boys look at each other. They stand up straight.]***

Rafi & Karim: *(together, clearly)* Assalamu Alaikum, Nanu. Assalamu Alaikum, Chacha.

Nanu: Wa Alaikum Assalam! See? That is already ten times better.

Chacha: *(nodding seriously, but with a small smile)* Correct greeting. Correct volume. Now — let us test you further.

****[Chacha begins to walk across the room. Rafi steps aside quickly to give him space. Karim, however, is standing right in the path and doesn't move.]***

Chacha: *(stopping in front of Karim)* Young man. When an elder is walking — what do you do?

Karim: *(thinking hard)* I... move?

Chacha: You move. You step aside. You do not make an elder walk around you. Understand?

Karim: Yes, Chacha. Sorry, Chacha.

Chacha: *(waving his hand kindly)* No need to be sorry. Just remember.

Nanu: Now — one more thing. Rafi, tell Karim what we do in our family when we greet a very respected elder. Like your grandfather. Or your great-uncle.

Rafi: *(to Karim, quietly)* Some families touch the feet of their elders. It is a very deep sign of respect. In Hindu families, many people do it too. It means: I honour you. Your wisdom is greater than mine.

Karim: Does it feel strange?

Rafi: At first. But when you see how happy it makes them... it actually feels good. Like you did something real.

Nanu: *(softly)* It is not about the action itself. It is about the heart behind it. Respect is not just what you do. It is what you mean.

Chacha: Well said, sister. *(to the boys)* Now — shall we have tea? And perhaps you two can sit quietly like the fine young men you are?

Rafi: *(grinning)* We can try.

Karim: *(grinning back)* No promises.

****[Everyone laughs. Nanu shakes her head fondly.]***

[END OF SCENE]

Key Words

English	Bengali	What It Means
Nanu	নানু [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Maternal grandmother — your mother's mother
Dadu	দাদু [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Paternal grandmother — your father's mother
Chacha	চাচা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Uncle — father's brother (also used for respected older men in the neighbourhood)
Mama	মামা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Uncle — mother's brother
Respect	সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Treating someone with care, honour, and attention
Greet	অভিবাदन [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	To welcome someone with a kind word or gesture

Discussion Questions

- 1. Why do we stand when an elder enters the room?** Think about it: when you stand up, you are showing with your body that the person matters. You are not saying "I am comfortable — you figure it out." You are saying: "I see you. I honour you." What does sitting still when someone enters say instead?
- 2. How would you feel if a younger child spoke rudely to you — talked over you, or didn't greet you?** Imagine you worked very hard on something, and a younger child completely ignored you. How would that feel? Now imagine the same child looked at you and said, "Hello, I'm glad to see you." How does that feel different?
- 3. Name one elder in your life you want to show more respect to — and think of one specific way you could do it.** This could be your grandmother, your grandfather, a neighbour, a teacher, or an older relative you don't see often. What is one thing you could do this week that you haven't done before?

What Would You Do?

The Situation: You are on a crowded local bus. You have a seat. An elderly woman gets on. She is carrying a bag and has to hold the rail to stand. What do you do?

Choice A — Pretend not to notice. You look at the window. You think: "Maybe someone else will give their seat." The bus jolts. The elderly woman almost falls. Nobody moves. She stands for the whole journey, looking tired. *What does this choice say about you?*

Choice B — Offer her your seat directly. You stand up and say, "Please, aunty, sit here." She smiles and thanks you. You hold the rail for the rest of the journey. You feel a little uncomfortable — but also proud. *What does this choice say about you?*

Choice C — Ask someone else to give their seat. You tap the person next to you and say, "Excuse me, bhai, can you give your seat to this aunty?" The other person looks annoyed. The aunty is embarrassed. Nothing changes. *Was this the right approach? Could it have worked better? What would you say differently?*

Write or discuss: Which choice is most respectful? Which is easiest? Which is hardest? Why?

Try It At Home

Choose one elder in your home — a parent, grandparent, older sibling, or aunt/uncle.

Do **one special act of respect** for them today — without being asked, and without telling them you are doing it for school.

Ideas:

- Bring them a glass of water
- Stand when they enter the room
- Greet them with Assalamu Alaikum when you see them in the morning
- Offer to carry something heavy for them

Tomorrow in class, share what you did and how it felt.

Teacher Notes: Assign character roles at least 5 minutes before the role play begins. Encourage students playing Rafi and Karim to be expressive and energetic — the contrast with polite behaviour is funnier and more memorable that way. After the role play, debrief with: "Who showed the most respect in the scene? Why? What was the turning point for Karim?" Optionally, re-run the scene with a student volunteering as Rafi who does NOT improve — to show the contrast.

Parent Corner | অভিভাবক কর্নার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]: This week, your child is learning to respect elders. This includes greeting properly, offering seats, not interrupting, and giving elders space when walking. When your child shows one of these behaviours at home — even imperfectly — please acknowledge and praise them specifically. Say: "I noticed you stood up when Uncle came in. That was very respectful." Specific praise sticks.

Chapter 2: Greetings for Every Place

Virtue: Respect | সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will use the correct greeting for at least 4 different social contexts.

Role Play: "Good Morning, Good Day, Good Everything"

Characters:

- **Mitu** — 8 years old, curious and eager to do things right
- **Rafi** — 8 years old, Mitu's classmate, sometimes guesses wrong
- **Teacher Ayesha Ma'am** — warm but firm
- **Mr. Shuvo** — the market shopkeeper, cheerful and talkative

(Note: In Scenes 3 and 4, additional community characters can be played by classmates.)

Scene 1: Home — Greeting Parents in the Morning

**[SCENE: Mitu's home, early morning. Mitu comes out of her room, hair still a little messy, to find her mother cooking.]*

Mitu: (yawning, walking straight past her mother towards the kitchen shelf) Is breakfast ready?

Mother: (without turning) ...

Mitu: (grabbing a roti) I'm eating this, okay?

Mother: (turning slowly) Mitu. We start again.

Mitu: (sighing) Okay, okay. (She goes back to the hallway. Enters again properly. Smiles.)

Mitu: Assalamu Alaikum, Ammu. Good morning.

Mother: (*warmly*) Wa Alaikum Assalam, my love. Good morning. Now yes — breakfast is ready.

Mitu: (*to herself, to the audience*) See? It only takes three seconds. But it changes everything about how the morning feels.

Scene 2: School — Greeting the Teacher Before Class

****[SCENE: Class 3 classroom. Students are entering. Rafi rushes in, dumps his bag loudly, and drops into his seat, not looking at anyone.]***

Teacher Ayesha: (*standing at the front*) Good morning, everyone.

All students (except Rafi): Good morning, Ma'am!

Teacher Ayesha: (*looking at Rafi*) Rafi?

Rafi: (*startled*) Oh! Um — good morning, Ma'am.

Teacher Ayesha: Thank you. Now — when you enter a classroom, what is the first thing you do?

Rafi: Sit down?

Mitu: (*whispering*) Greet the teacher!

Rafi: Right — greet the teacher. Sorry, Ma'am.

Teacher Ayesha: It is fine, Rafi. But think about it. When you walk in and say nothing to me — how does that feel to me?

Rafi: (*honestly*) Like I didn't notice you?

Teacher Ayesha: Exactly. And I am here every morning, preparing for your lesson, thinking about all of you. A simple "Good morning, Ma'am" tells me: I see you. I respect your work. That is all it takes.

Mitu: Ma'am, what if we don't know what language the teacher speaks? Like if we visit another school?

Teacher Ayesha: A respectful nod and a smile work in any language. But words, when you know them — use them. And in our school, "Good morning, Ma'am" or "Assalamu Alaikum, Ma'am" — both are correct and both are kind.

Scene 3: The Market — Greeting the Shopkeeper

****[SCENE: A small neighbourhood market. Mr. Shuvo is arranging vegetables. Rafi approaches.]***

Rafi: (*walking up confidently*) Hey! How much is this?

Mr. Shuvo: (*looking up, not unkindly*) Ten taka.

Rafi: Okay. (*drops coins on the counter and walks away*)

****[Mitu approaches the same shopkeeper a moment later.]***

Mitu: Assalamu Alaikum, uncle. How are you today?

Mr. Shuvo: (*smiling broadly*) Wa Alaikum Assalam, didi! I'm very well, thank you! What can I get for you?

Mitu: How much is this brinjal?

Mr. Shuvo: For you? Eight taka. (*winks*) Good manners get good prices.

Mitu: (*laughing*) Thank you, uncle!

******[Later — Rafi is watching. He approaches Mr. Shuvo again.]*

Rafi: Assalamu Alaikum, uncle. Can I try that again?

Mr. Shuvo: (*pretending to be surprised*) Who is this polite young man? Of course!

Rafi: (*laughing*) Okay. I understand now.

Scene 4: The Mosque — A Quiet, Respectful Greeting

******[SCENE: The entrance of the local masjid. A small group of worshippers is present. Rafi enters and spots his classmate across the room. He raises his hand to wave.]*

Rafi: (*starting to call out*) HEY, KAR—

******[An older worshipper nearby gives him a gentle look. Rafi stops himself. He lowers his voice.]*

Rafi: (*very quietly, walking over*) Assalamu Alaikum. (*He gives a small nod and a quiet smile.*)

Karim: (*equally quiet*) Wa Alaikum Assalam. You nearly shouted.

Rafi: (*whispering*) I know. I caught myself.

Karim: (*whispering*) This is a quiet place. Even greetings have to be quiet here.

******[An imam walks past. Both boys give a respectful nod. The imam nods back warmly, clearly pleased.]*

Rafi: (*to audience, quietly*) Different places ask different things from us. The greeting is the same — but the volume and the way we do it changes. That is part of respect.

[END OF SCENE]

Key Words

Greeting	Bengali	When and How to Use It
Assalamu Alaikum	আসসালামু আলাইকুম [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The Islamic greeting — used among Muslims of all ages; can be said at any time of day
Wa Alaikum Assalam	ওয়া আলাইকুম আস-সালাম [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The reply to Assalamu Alaikum
Adab	আদাব [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A respectful greeting gesture — hand raised to forehead; used across communities
Nomoshkar	নমস্কার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A respectful greeting used in Hindu communities; hands pressed together
Shaking hands	—	Appropriate between men/boys; always use the right hand

Respectful nod	—	Appropriate in quiet places, with women/girls, or when words are not needed
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Discussion Questions

- 1. Why do we greet differently in different places?** Think about the scenes you watched. Why was "Hey!" fine for a playground but not for a mosque? Why was "How much is this?" less warm than "Assalamu Alaikum, uncle"? The place, the relationship, and the mood of the space all shape how we greet. Can you think of another place that has its own greeting rules?
- 2. What greeting would you use with a non-Muslim classmate?** In Bangladesh, we live and study alongside people of many faiths. If your classmate is Hindu, "Nomoshkar" or "Adab" are both respectful. "Good morning" works too. The question is: did you make them feel seen? That is the heart of any greeting.
- 3. Does it matter if you don't know the right greeting — or should you try anyway?** Imagine you are in a new neighbourhood and you're not sure how people greet each other. Is it better to say nothing, or to try your best even if you get it slightly wrong? What do you think the other person would prefer?

What Would You Do?

The Situation: You enter the mosque after Friday prayers. Across the room, you see your best friend Karim. You are happy to see him. What do you do?

Choice A — Shout "Hey!" across the room. Several people nearby look startled. An elderly man who was making du'a loses his concentration. Karim looks embarrassed. *Was this respectful? Why not?*

Choice B — Wave quietly from where you are. Karim sees you. He smiles and nods. You will talk properly when you both leave. *Is this okay? What are its limits?*

Choice C — Walk quietly across the room and greet him softly. You say "Assalamu Alaikum" in a low voice. He replies. You both smile. No one is disturbed. *What made this the best choice?*

Discuss: Is it possible to be joyful AND quiet at the same time? Can respect and happiness go together?

Try It At Home

Today, greet every person you meet with the correct greeting for that situation:

- At home: Assalamu Alaikum when you wake up
- To a non-Muslim friend or neighbour: Adab or Nomoshkar
- At a shop: a proper greeting before your question
- Anywhere quiet: a gentle nod and a soft word

Keep a mental count. Tomorrow in class, share: How many people looked surprised? How many smiled? Did anything change in the conversation because of how you greeted them?

Teacher Notes: Before the role play, spend 5 minutes physically practising all 4 greetings as a class. Line students up and have them greet each other in each style: Assalamu Alaikum with hand to heart, Adab with hand raised, Nomoshkar with hands pressed together, handshake, and the quiet nod. Make it fun. Students will remember greetings they have performed in their bodies far better than ones they have only read.

Parent Corner | অভিভাবক কর্নার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]: This week, your child is learning that different greetings belong in different places. Please reinforce this at home: when cousins visit, when you go to a neighbour, when you attend religious gatherings. When your child uses an appropriate greeting naturally, point it out: "I noticed you greeted Uncle properly. Well done." When you visit relatives of other faiths, show your child how you greet them — and explain why.

Chapter 3: I Am Polite in Public

Virtue: Responsibility | দায়িত্ব [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will name 5 public behaviour rules and explain the impact of breaking them.

Role Play: "The Bus to Anywhere"

Characters:

- **Mitu** — 8 years old, thoughtful and observant
- **Mitu's Mother** — calm, uses the moment to teach
- **Elderly Man (Dada)** — tired, carrying a small bag, standing in the aisle
- **Rude Boy** — no name given; represents choices, not a person

**[SCENE: A crowded CNG-style bus in Dhaka. It is hot. People are pressed together. The bus stops. Several people try to get on.]*

**[The Rude Boy reaches the door first. He shoves past two people — including Mitu — to get on first.]*

Rude Boy: Move, move! I was here first!

Mitu: (stumbling slightly) Hey—

Mother: (steadyying Mitu) It's okay. Let's get on calmly.

******[Inside the bus, the Rude Boy spots a seat marked with a small sign: "Reserved for Elderly / Pregnant / Disabled." He sits in it immediately and pulls out his phone. Loud music plays from the speaker — no earphones.]*

Rude Boy: *(to no one in particular)* Finally!

******[An elderly man — Dada — boards the bus slowly. He is holding a bag. He looks at the reserved seat. He looks at the Rude Boy, who is absorbed in his phone. Dada holds the rail and stands, swaying slightly.]*

Mitu: *(watching, to her mother quietly)* Ammu. That is the reserved seat.

Mother: *(nodding)* Yes. What should happen?

Mitu: *(standing up)* Sir — dada — please sit here.

Dada: *(surprised and grateful)* Oh! Thank you, my child. Thank you very much.

******[Mitu stands, holding the rail. Her mother smiles.]*

Mitu: *(to audience)* I don't have to be the Rude Boy. I get to choose.

******[Meanwhile, the Rude Boy crumples up a small wrapper and drops it on the floor of the bus.]*

Mitu: *(looking at the wrapper, then at the Rude Boy, then deciding)* *(to the Rude Boy, politely but clearly)* Excuse me. I think you dropped something.

Rude Boy: *(barely looking up)* It's fine. Someone will clean it.

Mitu: This is a shared space. If everyone thought that, it would be very dirty.

Rude Boy: *(shrugs, goes back to phone)*

Mother: *(quietly to Mitu)* You did the right thing. You said it. That matters — even if he didn't listen.

Mitu: *(picking up the wrapper and putting it in her bag)* I still don't want it on the floor.

Dada: *(from his seat, overhearing)* Young lady. You are going to be someone very fine. I can tell.

Mitu: *(smiling, a little embarrassed)* Thank you, dada.

******[The bus continues. The Rude Boy's music plays on. He is isolated in his bubble. Mitu and her mother chat quietly. Dada rests. The contrast is clear.]*

Mother: Mitu. What is the difference between that boy and you — right now?

Mitu: He thinks public space belongs to him. I know it belongs to everyone.

Mother: *(nodding slowly)* That. Exactly that.

[END OF SCENE]

Public Behaviour Rules — Remember These 6

1. **Queue properly.** Wait your turn. Do not push or shove to be first.
2. **Don't push.** Other people's bodies are not obstacles for you to move.
3. **Give up your seat** for elderly people, pregnant women, people with disabilities, and young children.
4. **Don't litter.** Your rubbish is your responsibility until you find a bin.

5. **Use your indoor voice.** Loud music, loud talking — these steal the peace from everyone around you.
6. **Respect shared spaces.** Public buses, parks, markets, waiting rooms — they belong to all of us equally.

Discussion Questions

1. **How does one rude person affect everyone else on the bus?** Think about it: the Rude Boy's loud music affected everyone in earshot. His pushing affected the people at the door. His dropped wrapper affected the floor Dada might slip on. One person acting badly does not affect just that person — it spreads. Can you think of a "domino" effect of one rude choice?
2. **Why is it hard to stand up and be polite when others aren't?** Mitu spoke to the Rude Boy. That took courage. When everyone is being noisy, being quiet feels strange. When nobody else gives up their seat, giving yours feels lonely. Why do you think it is harder to be polite when those around us aren't? What gives us the strength to do it anyway?
3. **What can you do if you see someone littering?** There are several options, and they all have different results. Think about: What do you say? How do you say it? What tone? What if they ignore you? Is picking it up yourself — even their rubbish — a valid choice? Discuss.

What Would You Do?

The Situation: You are walking down the street with a friend. An adult ahead of you drops a plastic wrapper on the ground — not by accident. They keep walking.

Choice A — Ignore it. You keep walking. The wrapper lies on the street. By evening, the wind has blown it into the drain. It will stay there for years. *What did your silence say?*

Choice B — Pick it up silently. You walk over, pick up the wrapper, and carry it until you find a bin. You didn't embarrass anyone. You just fixed the problem quietly. *Is this enough? What are the limits of this choice?*

Choice C — Say politely: "Excuse me, you dropped something." The adult turns. Maybe they look embarrassed and pick it up. Maybe they ignore you. Maybe they say "mind your business." But you named what happened, calmly and respectfully. *What courage does this take? What might happen? Is it worth it?*

Discuss: Which choice is easiest? Which has the most impact? Can you do more than one at once?

Try It At Home

On your next trip outside — to the market, to school, to a relative's house, anywhere in public — become an observer.

Notice and count:

- **3 examples of good public behaviour** (someone giving a seat, someone queuing properly, someone using a quiet voice)
- **3 examples of poor public behaviour** (pushing, littering, making noise in a quiet space)

Teacher Notes: Before the role play, rearrange classroom chairs into two rows facing each other like a bus. Assign seats. Tell the class: "You are on a bus." This physical setup makes the role play immediate and vivid. Designate one chair as the "reserved seat" with a piece of paper. After the role play, keep the chairs and run a short second round where students improvise new scenarios: someone eating smelly food, someone spreading their bag across two seats, etc.

Parent Corner | অভিভাবক কর্নার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]: This week, when you are out with your child — on a bus, at the market, in any public space — narrate good and poor behaviour as you see it (quietly). Ask your child: "Was that polite? Why or why not?" You do not need to lecture. A question is enough. Your child is learning to observe and evaluate the world around them. Help them practise this by asking rather than telling.

Chapter 4: Holy Places, Quiet Hearts

Virtue: Respect | সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will demonstrate appropriate behaviour in religious and community spaces.

Role Play: "The Day Rafi Almost Ruined Everything"

Characters:

- **Rafi** — 8 years old, enthusiastic, sometimes moves before he thinks
- **Rafi's Father (Abbu)** — patient, uses questions to teach
- **Imam Saheb** — calm, speaks gently but seriously
- **A Worshipper (Boro Bhai)** — a teenager, acts as a friendly guide

****[SCENE:** Outside a neighbourhood masjid after Friday prayers. The congregation is beginning to leave, but some worshippers are still inside making du'a. Rafi and his father are arriving a little late.]*

Rafi: (*whispering loudly as they approach the entrance*) Abbu, why are we walking so slowly? We're late!

Father: (*quietly*) Lower your voice, Rafi. We are near the masjid.

Rafi: (*lowering to a slightly less loud whisper*) But Abbu—

Father: (*gently stopping*) Before we go in. What do we do first?

Rafi: (*thinking*) Oh. (*He looks down at his feet.*) Shoes.

Father: Shoes.

******[They both remove their shoes. Rafi's are tied with double knots. He struggles. A teenager nearby — Boro Bhai — glances over and smiles but doesn't say anything.]*

Rafi: *(finally getting them off, a little out of breath)* Okay. Done.

Father: Good. And inside?

Rafi: Quiet. No running. *(He pauses.)* No phone — but I don't have a phone, so that's easy.

Father: *(suppressing a smile)* One day you will. Remember it then.

******[They enter. Rafi immediately spots his friend Karim across the prayer hall. Rafi raises his arm to wave enthusiastically.]*

Father: *(very quietly, hand on Rafi's arm)* Rafi.

Rafi: *(catching himself)* Oh. *(He lowers his arm. He walks quietly towards Karim instead and gives a soft Assalamu Alaikum with a nod.)*

Karim: *(equally quiet)* Wa Alaikum Assalam.

******[Nearby, the Imam Saheb is helping an elderly worshipper. He notices the boys and gives a gentle, approving nod.]*

******[Suddenly, from the back of the room — a phone goes off. A very loud ringtone: a popular song. Everyone looks. A man scrambles desperately to silence it, face red. He gets up and hurries out. The worshippers who were in du'a look up, distracted.]*

Rafi: *(to his father, whispering)* That was terrible.

Father: *(nodding)* It happens. What did he do wrong?

Rafi: Forgot to silence his phone.

Father: And what should he have done?

Rafi: Silenced it before coming in. Or left it outside.

Father: And when it rang — what did he do right?

Rafi: *(thinking)* He left quickly. He didn't keep talking.

Father: *(nodding)* Even mistakes can be handled with respect. That matters too.

******[Later. Outside. Rafi and Boro Bhai are putting their shoes back on.]*

Rafi: Boro Bhai, does everyone have to behave this way? Even people who are not Muslim?

Boro Bhai: *(thoughtfully)* Have you ever been inside a Hindu mandir? Or a church?

Rafi: No.

Boro Bhai: They have the same kinds of rules. Remove your shoes at the temple. Speak quietly in the church. Don't disturb those who are praying. Every holy place — in every religion — asks for the same thing: that you come in with a quiet heart.

Rafi: A quiet heart. I like that.

Boro Bhai: Respect for a holy place is the same, even if the prayers inside are different. When you walk into any holy space — any — treat it the way you would want someone to treat yours.

Rafi: *(quietly, to himself)* Quiet heart. Got it.

[END OF SCENE]

Rules for Holy Places

In the Masjid:

- Remove shoes at the entrance
- Walk quietly — no running
- Turn off or silence your phone before entering
- Do not disturb those who are praying or in du'a
- Speak only in a low voice
- Maintain wudu (cleanliness) if entering the prayer area

In any Holy Place (temple, church, gurudwara, or other):

- Follow the specific customs of that space (ask if unsure)
- Dress modestly and appropriately
- Be still and quiet
- Observe before you act — watch what others are doing
- Treat the space with the same care you would want others to show your own holy place

Discussion Questions

- 1. Why is silence important in a holy place?** Think about what people come to a holy place to do: pray, reflect, feel close to God, find peace. Every loud noise breaks that. It is like someone laughing in the middle of an important moment. Silence is not emptiness — it is a gift you give to everyone around you.
- 2. Have you ever been somewhere and felt you had to be very careful how you behaved?** Not just a holy place — maybe a hospital, a formal gathering, a relative's very tidy home, or a special ceremony. What was it? Why did you feel the need to be careful? Who told you — or did you just sense it?
- 3. How would you feel if someone was disruptive during something important to you?** Imagine it is Eid. You are with your family in a special moment of prayer. A child behind you is shouting and running around. How does that feel? Hold that feeling — and remember it next time you are in someone else's important space.

What Would You Do?

The Situation: You forgot to silence your phone before entering the masjid. During a quiet moment, it rings loudly.

Choice A — Answer it. You pick up and whisper "I'll call you back." Everyone nearby hears you. You have now disrupted twice — once with the ring, once with the call. *What is wrong with this choice?*

Choice B — Scramble to silence it, then leave quietly to deal with it. You silence it as fast as you can, make an apologetic gesture to those nearby, and slip out to call back outside. *Is this a good recovery? What does it show?*

Choice C — Leave it ringing, frozen with embarrassment. The phone rings four full times. Then voicemail. The disruption lasts much longer. *What should you have done instead?*

Discuss: What is the lesson before the problem even happens? How do you prevent the situation entirely?

Try It At Home

This week, visit a religious place — your local masjid, or any other holy place accessible to you.

Before you go in, think: What are the expected behaviours here?

While inside, observe: What are people doing? How do they move? How do they speak?

Afterwards, write down or draw:

1. Two things you did to show respect in that space
2. One thing you want to remember for next time

Teacher Notes: *This chapter requires cultural sensitivity. Bangladesh's population includes Muslim, Hindu, Christian, Buddhist and other communities. Before beginning, ask students what holy places they are familiar with — not just mosques. Celebrate the range of answers. Make clear that respect for a holy place is universal, not specific to one religion. If any student has never visited a holy place, pair them with a student who has for the home activity reflection.*

Parent Corner | অভিভাবক কর্নার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]: *When visiting the mosque or any holy place this week, take a moment before entering to name the expected behaviours out loud with your child: "What do we do with our shoes? What is our voice like inside? What do we do with our phone?" This brief conversation before entering is far more effective than correcting inside. Your child is learning to prepare — not just react.*

Chapter 5: I'm Sorry, I Forgive — Apologies and Forgiveness

Virtue: Honesty + Kindness | সত্যতা + দয়া [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will demonstrate a sincere apology and gracious acceptance in a role play.

Role Play: "The Pencil Box"

Characters:

- **Rafi** — 8 years old, accidentally breaks something and must choose how to handle it
- **Mitu** — 8 years old, the one who is hurt; must decide whether to forgive
- **Teacher Ayesha Ma'am** — observes and guides
- **Karim** — Rafi's friend, a witness who tries to help

**[SCENE: The classroom at the end of the school day. Students are packing up. Rafi reaches past Mitu's desk to grab his bag — and knocks her pencil box off the desk. It hits the floor. The clasp breaks. Pencils scatter everywhere.]*

Mitu: *(looking at her pencil box, upset)* Rafi! My pencil box!

**[The class goes quiet.]*

Scenario A — The Wrong Choice: Pretend It Wasn't You

Rafi: *(quickly picking up his bag, not looking at Mitu)* It just fell. The table was shaky.

Mitu: You knocked it!

Rafi: *(defensively)* I barely touched it.

Karim: *(uncomfortable)* Rafi, we all saw—

Rafi: *(walking away)* It's not my fault. These things happen.

**[Mitu looks at the broken clasp. She looks at Rafi's back. She is hurt — not just about the pencil box.]*

Teacher Ayesha: *(quietly, to the class)* How does Mitu feel right now? And why does she feel worse than if the box had just fallen on its own?

**[CLASS DISCUSSION — pause the role play here.]*

Scenario B — The Wrong Choice Again: Saying Sorry Without Meaning It

**[The scene resets. Rafi knocks the pencil box again.]*

Mitu: Rafi! My pencil box!

Rafi: *(barely looking up, already reaching for his bag)* Sorry.

Mitu: Rafi, it's broken—

Rafi: I said sorry. *(shrugs and walks out)*

Teacher Ayesha: *(to the class)* Was that a real apology?

Students: No!

Teacher Ayesha: Why not?

Karim: He didn't even look at her.

Teacher Ayesha: Correct. He used the word. But an apology is not just a word. What else does it need?

Scenario C — The Real Apology

******[The scene resets one final time. Rafi knocks the pencil box.]*

Mitu: *(looking at the broken clasp, upset)* Rafi! My pencil box is broken!

Rafi: *(stopping. He turns around. He looks at the broken box. He looks at Mitu's face. He takes a breath.)*

Rafi: Mitu. I'm really sorry. I was rushing and I knocked it off your desk. That was careless of me.

Mitu: *(still upset)* It was a gift from my dadu.

Rafi: *(genuinely)* I didn't know that. I'm really sorry. Can I — is the box itself broken, or just the clasp? Maybe my baba can fix the clasp.

Mitu: *(looking at it)* Just the clasp.

Rafi: Can I take it home and try? And if it can't be fixed, I want to replace it. I'll ask Ammu.

Karim: *(quietly impressed)* Rafi.

Mitu: *(after a moment)* Okay. You can try. *(She pauses.)* And... I know it was an accident.

Rafi: Thank you, Mitu. I'll be more careful.

Teacher Ayesha: *(to the class)* What made that apology real?

Karim: He said exactly what he did wrong.

Teacher Ayesha: Good. What else?

Student: He looked at her. He meant it.

Teacher Ayesha: Yes. And?

Rafi: *(himself)* I asked how to fix it. I didn't just say sorry and run.

Teacher Ayesha: Exactly. And Mitu — you forgave him. How did that feel?

Mitu: Better than staying angry.

Teacher Ayesha: In our faith, we believe that when someone truly apologises — maaf, we call it — forgiving them is also a virtue. It is not weakness. It takes strength to let go. And it heals both people.

[END OF SCENE]

A Real Apology Has 4 Parts

Part	What It Looks Like
1. Name what you did wrong	"I knocked your pencil box off the desk and the clasp broke." — Be specific. Don't say "I'm sorry things happened."
2. Say you're sorry sincerely	Look at the person. Mean it. Your face and your voice have to match your words.

3. Ask what you can do to make it right	"Can I help fix it? Can I replace it? What do you need?" — Show that your sorry is connected to action.
4. Mean it — don't repeat the behaviour	The test of a real apology is what you do after. If you do the same thing again next week, the apology was not real.

Key Words

English	Bengali	What It Means
Apology	ক্ষমা প্রার্থনা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Asking forgiveness for something you did that caused hurt
Maaf	ক্ষমা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Forgiveness — from the Arabic/Islamic tradition; to release someone from blame
Sincere	আন্তরিক [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Genuine; coming from the heart; not just words
Forgiveness	ক্ষমা করা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Choosing to let go of anger toward someone who hurt you

Discussion Questions

- Is it easy or hard to say sorry? Why?** For most people, saying sorry is hard — even when they know they were wrong. Why? Sometimes pride is in the way. Sometimes we are afraid the other person will still be angry. Sometimes we don't want to admit we made a mistake. What makes it hard for you?
- When someone apologises to you sincerely — really means it — how does forgiving them feel?** Think of a time someone said sorry to you and you could tell they meant it. How did you feel? Lighter? Relieved? Connected again? Contrast that with when someone says sorry and you can tell they don't mean it — how is that different?
- Can you still be wrong even if you said sorry?** Saying sorry is the beginning of making things right — not the end. If Rafi had said "sorry" and then never returned the pencil box or offered to help, was the apology complete? What does "making it right" look like in practice?

What Would You Do?

The Situation: You were playing and accidentally said something that hurt your friend's feelings. You didn't mean to. They are now upset and have gone quiet.

Using the 4 Parts, plan your apology:

- Name what you did:** What specifically did you say that hurt them?
- Say you're sorry sincerely:** What words will you use — and how will you say them?

3. **Ask what you can do:** What could you offer? What would help them feel better?
4. **Mean it:** What will you do differently so it doesn't happen again?

Write your apology out before you practise it. Then practise it with a partner.

Try It At Home

Think of someone you may have hurt or upset recently — a sibling, a parent, a friend, a classmate. Even a small thing.

Before apologising, practise at home. Say the 4 parts out loud, to yourself or to a trusted person. Notice how it feels to say the words.

Then — when you are ready — go and say them for real.

You do not have to share the details with the class. Only share whether you did it — and how it felt afterwards.

Teacher Notes: Before running Scenario C, run Scenarios A and B with a pause for class discussion after each one. Let students diagnose what is wrong before seeing the correct version — this is far more powerful than showing the right answer first. In the debrief after Scenario C, ask: "What made that apology feel real?" Also model a sincere apology yourself: tell the class about a time you apologised sincerely (or needed to). This normalises apology as something adults do too — not just something children are told to do.

Parent Corner | অভিভাবক কর্নার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]: This week, your child is learning the four parts of a sincere apology. The most powerful thing you can do is model this yourself. When you make a mistake — with your child, with another adult, with anyone — apologise sincerely and let your child see it. Do not say "sorry, but..." (which undoes the apology). Just say what you did, say you are sorry, and show what you will do differently. This is one of the most lasting lessons a parent can teach.

End of Book: My Respect Map

Activity: Draw Your Respect Map

What you need: A blank page, a pencil or pen, and some colour if you have it.

What to do:

1. In the very centre of your page, draw a small circle and write **"ME"** inside it.
2. Around that, draw a slightly bigger ring. Label it: **HOME** Write 2 ways you show respect at home. (Examples: greet Ammu and Abbu in the morning / give up my seat for Nanu)

3. Draw another ring around that. Label it: **SCHOOL** Write 2 ways you show respect at school. *(Examples: greet my teacher / don't interrupt when a classmate is speaking)*
4. Draw another ring. Label it: **MASJID / TEMPLE / HOLY PLACE** Write 2 ways you show respect in holy spaces. *(Examples: remove my shoes / keep my phone silent)*
5. Draw the outermost ring. Label it: **PUBLIC SPACE** Write 2 ways you show respect in public. *(Examples: queue properly / don't litter)*

When you're done: Look at your map. You show respect in many places, in many different ways — every day. That is who you are becoming.

Share your map with a classmate. What did they write that you didn't think of?

Glossary

All the key words from this book, in alphabetical order.

English	Bengali	Definition
Adab	আদাব [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A respectful greeting — hand raised to forehead; used widely across communities in South Asia
Apology	ক্ষমা প্রার্থনা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A sincere expression of regret for having hurt someone; asking forgiveness
Assalamu Alaikum	আসসালামু আলাইকুম [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The Islamic greeting meaning "Peace be upon you"; the standard greeting among Muslims
Chacha	চাচা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Uncle — specifically father's brother; also used respectfully for older male community members
Dadu	দাদু [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Paternal grandmother — your father's mother
Forgiveness / Maaf	ক্ষমা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The act of releasing anger or blame toward someone who has hurt you; a virtue in Islam and many traditions
Greet	অভিবাদন [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	To welcome or acknowledge another person with words or gestures
Holy place	পবিত্র স্থান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A space dedicated to worship and prayer — a masjid, mandir, church, or other religious site
Kindness	দয়া [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Caring about the feelings and needs of others; acting warmly and gently
Litter	ময়লা ফেলা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Dropping rubbish in a public place instead of in a bin
Mama	মামা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Uncle — specifically mother's brother

Nanu	নানু [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Maternal grandmother — your mother's mother
Nomoshkar	নমস্কার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A respectful greeting used in Hindu communities; hands pressed together at the chest
Public space	সর্বজনীন স্থান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A space shared by all people — buses, markets, parks, footpaths
Queue	লাইনে দাঁড়ানো [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Standing in an orderly line and waiting your turn
Reserved seat	সংরক্ষিত আসন [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A seat set aside for people who need it most — elderly, pregnant, or disabled
Respect	সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Treating someone with care, attention, and honour; recognising their worth
Responsibility	দায়িত্ব [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Taking ownership of your actions and their effects on others
Sincere	আন্তরিক [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Genuine and honest — coming truly from the heart, not just from the lips
Virtue	গুণ / সদগুণ [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A positive quality of character that guides a person to do what is good and right
Wa Alaikum Assalam	ওয়া আলাইকুম আস-সালাম [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The reply to Assalamu Alaikum — "And upon you be peace"

Source Notes (Curriculum Team)

The following source references informed the content, context, and methodology of this textbook. All citations are for curriculum team use; they are not displayed to students.

- **Elder respect and greeting norms in Bangladesh:** [SOURCE_ALT_07][SOURCE_ALT_08] — Informed Chapter 1 (elder greeting protocols, touching feet as a sign of deep respect in Hindu/traditional contexts) and Chapter 2 (greeting variety across Muslim, Hindu, and community contexts in Bangladesh).
- **Public behaviour norms in Bangladesh:** [SOURCE_ALT_08] — Informed Chapter 3 (public transport etiquette, littering, seat-giving norms, queuing behaviour in urban Dhaka context).
- **Bullying prevalence and the importance of respectful behaviour:** [SOURCE_BD_09] — Contextual background for the broader unit; highlights why explicit teaching of respectful behaviour in peer and public contexts is a priority in the Bangladeshi primary school setting.
- **Role play methodology as a pedagogical tool for SEL:** [SOURCE_UK_03] — Foundational methodology reference for the role play scripts; supports use of scripted dramatic scenarios to build social-emotional competencies in ages 7–10.

- **SEL relationship skills framework:** [SOURCE_GL_01] — Framework reference for the "Respect" and "Responsibility" virtue categorisation; used to align learning objectives with internationally recognised SEL relationship skill competencies (communicating effectively, resolving conflict, demonstrating respect for others).
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[TRANSLATOR'S NOTE: All fields marked [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] require review and finalisation by a qualified Bengali-language education specialist before this document is used with students. Please ensure that translations are appropriate for the age group (8–9 years), regionally appropriate for Bangladesh, and reviewed for cultural accuracy.]